She Ra is Coming to Town

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Santa Claus Is Coming to Town (1970)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra)

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She Ra is Coming to Town

by Cloudiana

Summary

Catra of Frightburg had lived a rough life, but she beat the odds. She got a good education, a warm-ish couple rooms in a brownstone, and a decent-paying job as the local schoolteacher. No matter what life threw at her, she had built up a tough enough skin to take it.

But every so often, the universe decided to throw a new curveball to test her above it all demeanor.

A few days ago, it came in the form of a blonde weirdo in a bright red suit— a woman by the name of Adora Kringle.

A She-Ra Christmas Special based on “Santa Claus is Coming to Town”

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

There was a lot Catra had learned to put up with since moving to the City of Frightburg. The fact that every day was freezing and overcast. The fact that she was the only Magicat for miles. The weird ice wizard everyone said lived up on the foreboding Crystal Mountain. The zealous nut job Burgermeister Prime deciding to ban all toys because they distracted children from pursuing "true enlightenment".

Sure. Fine. She could live with all that. Frightburg was only marginally more miserable than the rest of this freezing continent she called home. Catra had lived a rough life, but she beat the odds. She got a good education, a warm-ish couple rooms in a brownstone, and a decent-paying job as the local schoolteacher. No matter what life threw at her, she had built up a tough enough skin to take it.

But every so often, the universe decided to throw a new curveball to test her above it all demeanor.

A few days ago, it came in the form of a blonde weirdo in a bright red suit— a woman by the name of Adora Kringle.

She just marched into town with more color than Frightburg had ever seen on one person with a sack full of toys. All the kids just getting out of Catra's classroom were thrilled at the chance to get replacements for the toys Prime seized and lined up to get one from her.

At first, Catra assumed this was just a bit of smart marketing by a peddler who heard about Prime's ban and decided to take advantage of the sudden increase in demand for playthings among the children of Frightburg, but the red-suited dork was just giving the toys away for free. Toys that were made, according to her, by the rest of the Kringles, a family of elves from beyond the Mountain of the Whispering Winds.

"So you're an elf from beyond the evil mountain no one has ever returned from," Catra had asked, annoyed, "Raised in the magical tundra by a family of toy makers. And you just happened to show up on the same day this town made toys illegal?"

"Oh no, ma'am. Don't be silly," she had responded. "I'm not an elf. I'm adopted."

"Oh yes," Catra had replied, rolling her eyes. "That makes sense. And is the weird red getup an elf thing too?"

Adora had thrown up her hands. "Again with the clothes," she shouted. "You're the third person to bring them up. This is just how people dress out in Brightmoon. What is color illegal here too?

"Oh, I'm sure Prime has already considered it," Catra had riposted. "That suit might finally push him over the edge."

“How about smiling?” Adora asked wryly. “Does that get you a night in jail too?” The assembled kids giggled.

“No, Prime’s not that unreasonable,” Catra replied with a shrug. “Smiling is just a misdemeanor. You’ll only get a light flogging.”

“Shame,” she sighed. “Personally, I think it’s a crime to discourage a smile as pretty as yours, Miss Catra.”

It only took Prime an hour to order her arrest. Honestly, Catra thought it was a miracle it took that long. The suit alone was a felony.

Shockingly, the city guard didn’t catch her. The woman must have been telling the truth about growing up on the tundra, because she ran like a deer, climbed like a squirrel, and was sippilier than a seal.

And stubborn as a mule. Catra thought as she wrapped up grading the last few assignments of the week. The winter wind knocked against her window, but she had plugged most of the drafts. She had tamped down the fire for the night, but a small stove in her bedroom corner was still burning, a hot mug of tea warming beside it.

Not content with causing a ruckus on Sunday, Adora had made a habit of sneaking into the city at night to continue distributing the festive contraband. All the little lawbreakers in her class had been

talking about how to help her make the deliveries without getting caught.

At first, they conspired to leave their doors unlocked so she could stash the goods by the fireplace, but once Prime caught on, the Burgermeister declared that all doors must be locked by sundown and stayed locked until sunrise, under penalty of a night in jail. She heard a rumble in her own front door as the city guard checked hers.

"Sooner they catch her, the better," Catra grumbled as she got into bed. Sure, Prime's law was stupid, but life was a neverending series of powerful morons making stupid rules. The only thing you could do was keep your head down, work hard, and hope for the best. Sure, it was harsh, especially for the kids, but they were bound to find that out some day.

Lord knew she found out fast.

A clatter on the roof jolted Catra out of her sleep. She drowsily looked out the window to see snow sliding off the roof. Reluctantly, the schoolteacher left her bed to get a closer look.

The street below was deserted and dark, but she had better night vision than most. In the dim moonlight, she could just make out

two sets of footprints in the fresh snow — a tiny pair with pronounced claws and one that came from a huge pair of snow boots. Suddenly, scratching noises came through the thin walls, like something was stuck in her chimney. *Like a raccoon. Or an an owl. Or an—*

"An outlaw," she growled. Throwing on her robe, Catra stalked out of her bedroom. She kept her apartment dark and drab, like the rest of Frightburg. Moving through it at night was like stepping into a black and white movie, especially when she didn't bring a lantern with her. The moonlight streaming weakly through the windows was the only light she needed.

"Come on Swiftie, you have to be quiet," an annoyingly familiar voice encouraged. "We can't wake anyone up." *Too late, dummy.* She peered down the staircase to find Adora searching through a burlap sack, red suit now covered in soot which she was tracking onto her floor. The one she *just cleaned, seriously! What is wrong with this woman?*

The bright red suit and hat made the intruder seem like a burning ember amidst cold, dull ash. She was almost too tall to go through any of the doorways in Catra's apartments. And here she thought elves were all supposed to be short. This woman was at least half-yeti.

"Ok," Adora asked the weird black and white bird at her side. The little guy had a rainbow scarf wrapped around his neck. "Do you think the kid who lives here would like a bag of marbles or a tiny rocking horse?" He squawked twice. "Horsey it is."

“How about an arrest warrant?” Catra asked. “Is that in your bag, Kringle?”

Adora jumped at the sound of her voice and spun around. “Miss Catra?” She exclaimed. “Oh I um—“ she blushed. “I have the wrong house don’t I?”

Catra nodded and turned the dial on the wall-mounted gaslight to get a better look at the adopted elf’s dumbstruck expression. “Yes, you do.” She deadpanned. “Sorry I’ve ruined your plans to get as many kids as possible on Prime’s bad side, all while waking up more law abiding Frightburg citizens with your bumbling.”

“I was not bumbling,” Adora shot back, offended. “I made it down that chimney gracefully. Maybe you’re just a light sleeper.”

“I’ll have you know I slept through my fair share of blizzards at the Orphanarium,” Catra responded.

“Well, if that’s the case,” Adora replied. “Maybe you can just go back to sleep and let me get back to work.”

“Work!?” Catra exclaimed. “You don’t have a job! You aren’t even a productive outlaw. They’re supposed to rob people, not give them free stuff!”

“My job *is* delivering toys to kids who need them,” she insisted. “It’s all I’ve ever wanted to do since I was old enough *to want*. I’m the only Kringle strong enough to haul all the toys the rest of my family makes through the tundra, over the Crystal Mountains, and through Whispering Woods.”

She threw up her hands. “I’ll admit, it hasn’t been going that well,” she continued. “But I’m not giving up. Kringles don’t quit. I had to fight a warlock to get these toys to Frightburg, and I’m not gonna let some dumb law get in the way of finishing the job.”

As she ranted, her hat fell in front of her eyes. She pushed it back up with a huff. “By all rights,” she continued. “I should have frozen to death when I was a baby and got left out in a blizzard— on a sled! But a reindeer found me and brought me back to Brightmoon. You know why?”

“It thought you were food?” Catra offered.

“You take that back! Blitzen does not eat children,” she cried, offended. “No, I was saved for a reason. Now, I know that reason was so that I could bring some joy back to the kids of this depressing town. If you’ll excuse me, I’ll get back to that.”

“I don’t think so, Kringle. I mean how can you expect anyone to get a good night's sleep when you’re out here, rustling up trouble with you’re stupid red suit, and stupid pretty eyes, and stupid little —“ she blushed as the slip of the tongue caught up to her. “You’re stupid little pet— What even is that thing anyway?”

“This is Swift Wind,” she explained. “He’s a penguin. I found him trying to get to the South Pole.” The bird squawked apologetically. “He’s about as lost as you can get.”

“That makes two of you,” Catra snarked. “Now, If you’ll excuse me, I’ll be calling the city guard.”

“Why are you doing this?” Adora challenged. “All the kids I’ve talked to think you’re really nice. Look” She reached into her coat and took out a bundle of papers. Catra cautiously reached out to snatch them. They turned out to be a bundle of drawings and short letters, all in colorful crayons. She recognized the handwriting. They were from her students all right.

“Dear Miss Adora,” read one. “Can I have sum letter blocks so I can play with my lil sister and get gooder at spellng? Miss Catra says I’m really smart.”

“Thanks for the toy boat,” read another. “I hope you like this picture I drew.” Most of the page was taken up by a drawing of a Magicat with a tight bun, the way she usually wore her hair. “P.S. I think she’s pretty too!”

“Can you give Miss Catra a toy too?” Asked a third. “She thinks the Burgermeister is dumb, but grown ups get in more trouble if they say that.”

Catra sighed and looked over her shoulder. “They’re good kids. And it’s a really, really stupid law,” she said. “That’s why I don’t want them getting in trouble over it. Better that they don’t have toys and stay out of the dungeons than they get caught up in your little rebellion.”

Adora’s face fell. “Please,” she pleaded, taking off her hat in surrender. “If you’re gonna call the city guard on me. Can you do me a favor?”

Catra crossed her arms. “What?” She demanded.

The woman reached a gloved hand into her sack and pulled out a porcelain doll. “Being the schoolteacher means you see the kids everyday, right?” She asked. “I didn’t really go to school, so I don’t know how it works, but if you get the chance, could you give this to Finn Fritzson? They asked for one when I was here the first time; they had one before, Prime burned it, but it was really special to them.”

Catra took the doll in her hands. She knew Finn. They had had a really rough year. A bout of pneumonia in the spring had lasted all the way to the first snowfall of the year. Poor kid had been in class for a few weeks total. Catra had made a few dozen worksheets to help the kid keep up with the rest of the class, but being stuck inside for so long without seeing their friends had taken a toll. Getting this doll would really mean the world to the kid.

And now that Adora mentioned it, the Magicat did recall the headmistress of the orphanage mentioning an incident where they

lost an infant abandoned in Frightburg after one of Prime's lackeys tried to bring it to them in the worst weather possible (because heaven forbid Prime have to put up with a baby in his mansion for one night). It would have been right around the same time she got left there. If the wind had blown a bit differently that night, they might have grown up together.

Catra sighed. "Fine," she said. "I'll see what I can do."

"Great! Thank you! Actually, if it's not too much extra trouble," she added. "All these toys were made for a specific kid. I've got a toy ice Knight called Winter's Bane for this kid named Frosta. A little train for Joe. A— oh! Hang on, I have a list if that would help. Checked it twice."

Catra rolled her eyes. "No, just go," she said. "I won't call the guard."

Adora blinked rapidly. "Oh! I knew all those kids were right about you, Miss Catra!" She yelled. "You won't regret this! I promise."

The penguin started flapping and clawing his way up the chimney, a surprisingly good climber. Adora moved to follow him. "I can just let you out the front door, you know?" Catra interjected.

Adora paused. "Oh, thanks," she replied. "But, if I'm gonna be sneaking in and out of houses like this all night, I should get some

more practice in. Apparently, I'm not very good at the 'not waking people up' part yet."

Catra laughed. "You got that right, princess," she said. "Your whole 'charming goofball' routine won't work on most people in this town."

The adopted elf tipped her spot-covered hat and winked. "And here I thought it wasn't working on you, Miss Catra."

The Magicat rolled her eyes. "I'm not doing this because I like you," she countered. "I just want to see the look on Prime's face when he realizes he got outsmarted again by you of all people."

It was Adora's turn to laugh. "I saw the wanted posters on the way in," she said. "'Wanted Dead or Alive: The Terrible Toymaker.'I've got to remember to take some home. Glimmer's gonna think they're hilarious."

"Yeah, maybe next time you can bring that toy Greta asked you to give me." Catra added as Adora started climbing up the chimney.

Adora stopped. "Oh," she said, blushing slightly. "Well, since you asked." She pulled out a small wooden box from her bag. "I may have made something in the workshop," she admitted. "You didn't seem like a person who liked toys all that much, so I tried to make it practical."

Catra smirked. “And what’s your take on practical?” She asked. “Jingle bells?”

The honorary elf handed it over. The box was elegantly designed, dark and light woods carefully inlaid, carved, strained, and polished. The little thing radiated care and craftsmanship. Catra peaked inside to find a writing quill resting on the velvet lined interior. “It’s for writing,” she explained. “Bow suggested I make a pencil case since you’re a teacher. I went a little overboard, but do you like it?”

“It’s beautiful,” Catra said quietly. *Best gift anyone’s ever got me.* she thought. *And not just because it’s the first.*

“It’s not too much, is it?” Adora asked, worry clear on her face. “Glimmer said it might scare you off. Not that I’m thinking about not scaring you off— I mean I don’t want to scare you or anything but—“ Catra’s barely restrained laughter cut her off. She blushed hard. “Sorry. I’m a lot better at making toys and running from guards than I am at talking to pretty girls,” she said apologetically.

Catra raised an eyebrow. “Do they not have pretty girls in Brightmoon?” She asked. “Or are you really the only one?”

Adora leaned back on the brick chimney. “None like you,” she said with a smile. “I’ve never met anyone like you, Miss Catra.”

“Just Catra is fine, Kringle,” she said. An irritated honk echoed down the chimney. “You better get going before your penguin wakes up the whole block.”

Adora nodded. “Yeah, but—“ she started nervously.

Catra waved her off and walked back up the stairs. “I’ll meet you by the chestnut grove outside of town tomorrow after class,” she said. “If you can avoid getting caught, I’m sure the kids will have more letters for you.”

Adora smiled. “Thank you, Catra,” she said. “I’ll be there bright and early. I promise.” With that, she scurried up the chimney at a speed that would embarrass a squirrel. “Did you hear that Swiftie?” She asked, her voice muffled by walls and snow. “She likes me!”

Catra rolled her eyes as she slipped back into her room. “At least if toy delivery doesn’t work out she has a nice backup career as a chimney sweep,” the Magicat said as she snuggled back into bed. The sheets were practically frozen, but somehow she felt warmer than she’d been in years.

She could picture the look on Finn’s face when they found that doll sitting next to the fireplace. The schoolteacher smiled so hard at the image her cheeks hurt. She would have to give the kids a crash course on stashing contraband, but she had more experience in that department than anyone responsible for hiring her knew about. Maybe she could also give Adora some tips to

keep her from getting caught, or at the very least she could find a way to break her out of the dungeons when she inevitably did.

Cara giggled at the thought of getting to be her knight in shining armor. “Tomorrow can’t come soon enough,” she muttered affectionately as she drifted off to sleep. “Stay safe out there, you big dork.”

End Notes

Merry Christmas! I hope you enjoyed this one shot. I might come back to add more scenes in the future, but this will have to do for now. If you enjoyed it, consider leaving a kudos or comment.

It's been a long, hard year. Not as bad as 2020 by a mile, and full of some incredible memories, but still, congrats on everyone for making it to the end of 2021. Thank you to everyone who's ever read or commented on my stories this year. You got me through the last semester of 1L, the start of 2L, and everything in between. Your kind words always mean a lot to me.

Anyway, I promised some warm, fuzzy fluff after the angst hurricane in the latest chapter of Full Moon Fever, and here it is. I've always loved this Christmas special (must have watched it a thousand times as a kid), and I thought there was some Catradora potential.

I hope you enjoyed this little story. And I hope you all have a merry Christmas if you celebrate, a happy holiday season, and a great New Year!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!